

COMMUNICATION STUDIES

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

March 2026

Southwestern was well represented at the Western States Communication Association annual conference in San Diego from February 27–March 2. Two students from Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar**'s fall capstone class presented research at the Undergraduate Scholars Research Conference. **Chloe London Jordan** '26 presented her capstone paper "Return to Whiteness: How 'Return to the Land' Platforms White Supremacy" and **John Reese** '26 presented "Deconstructing Far-Right Rhetoric on X: A Case Study of the X Account End Wokeness." Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** was there to clap and cheer before presenting her work with Dr. Kirsti Cole from North Carolina State University titled "The Weight of Stigma" about GLP-1 discourse.

January 2026

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** was featured as an interview source in a set of recent news stories produced by News 6 in Tulsa, OK, as part of their Roadside Memorial Project. The project, directed by News 6 reporter Katie Eastman, is comprised of several stories originally broadcast between December 22–26, 2025, including a

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November 2025

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published the article “Muscular Anti-Muslim Sentiment” in the journal *Women’s Studies in Communication*. The article examines the overlaps between muscular Hinduism and muscular Zionism and how they function together transnationally. You can read more [here](#).

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** presented an invited lecture titled “Remembering Jessie Daniel Ames: A Legacy of Social Activism Connecting Southwestern and Georgetown,” as part of the Preservation Georgetown Lecture Series, on October 15.

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) delivered a virtual invited talk titled "The Role of the Critic" to graduate students at Arizona State University. The graduate students were dope and gave LB hope.

April 2025

Herman Brown Chair and Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** returned to Postira, Croatia last week for the 7th Days of Ivo Škarić rhetoric conference. She presented a paper titled "The Weight of Stigma," co-authored with Kirsti Cole of North Carolina State University. This international conference featured rhetorical scholars from 10 countries across three continents.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** coauthored the forum essay, "Centering Latin America: gender politics, attacks on higher education, and lessons of resistance from Brazil," with Dr. Raiana Carvalho of Furman University. The piece, published in the National Communication Association's journal *Communication Education*, argues that by centering Latin America, and Brazil in particular, we hope to disrupt the hegemonic narrative that foregrounds the United States as the primary spreader of anti-higher education conservative ideologies. Instead, we offer evidence that these far-right attacks are transnational in nature, and that Latin America is at the center of both the articulation of

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Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published the article “Caste-Attentiveness” in the *Quarterly Journal of Speech*, the #1 ranked journal in communication studies. In this article, LB refuses caste as an “India-specific” problem and places it alongside anti-indigeneity, anti-Blackness, and settler colonialism as a global system demanding unrelenting critical attention. [Read more here.](#)

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their research at the 2025 Undergraduate Scholars Research Conference hosted by the Western States Communication Association. This marks the fourth conference Dr. Bahrainwala has mentored her students through. Faculty reviewers and the conference chair commended the students afterwards and attempted to recruit them to their graduate programs. **Mia Santoscoy** '26 presented her paper "The Dehumanization of Palestinians in U.S. Media: Animal rhetoric through death tolls, Instagram infographics, CNN, and X." Mia also received a standing ovation from the faculty speakers at the Palestine Solidarity day-long workshop on February 14. **Vanessa Villarreal** '25 presented her paper "Mean Girl Feminism: Latina Narratives, TikTok, and the Fight Against Misogyny." **Elisabeth Barlin** '25 presented her paper "Sexy, Cute, and Popular to Boot: The Satirizing of Cheerleading within *Bring It On*." Congratulations to these outstanding students.

February 2025

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) has secured a donation of two dozen volumes by Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar from the Ambedkarite Buddhist Association of Texas (ABAT). Dr. Ambedkar is one of the world's most important contemporary thinkers, and authored the Constitution of India, the world's largest democracy. He is also a leading anti-caste and Black-solidarity activist who has collaborated with W.E.B. DuBois to explore the overlapping injustices against Black and Dalit individuals. Metadata and Discovery Librarian **Hong Yu** and Director of the A. Frank Smith, Jr. Library Center **Casey Duncan** processed and catalogued the materials for the Library Center. In honor of Black History Month and this important donation, please join us for a special panel and refreshments in the Periodicals Room in the Library (the "First Thursdays" room) on Thursday, February 20, from 1:00 – 2:30 p.m. The panelists include Ambedkarite scholars from UT Austin, and members from ABAT who will contextualize the donation.

January 2025

On January 9, the **Mission-Driven Medicine** website was launched. The website is the culmination of a project carried out by the Summer 2024 Organizational Communication class taught by Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar**, and features the work of **Lauren Chisholm '24**, **Alexa Delenela '25**, **Tre Flores '26**, **Lauren Wise '25**, and **Justin Zamora '24**. The website is a fieldwork-based public-facing humanities project analyzing the organizational communication at the Houston Methodist Hospital system.

Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** published "Third-Wave Feminist Rhetoric in the 21st Century: Rethinking Limitations, Possibilities, and New Directions" with her frequent co-author Stacey Sowards. The chapter appears in *The Routledge Handbook of Contemporary Feminist Rhetoric*, edited by Jacqueline Rhodes and Suban Nur Cooley. The chapter is a retrospective of the 20 years since the duo began writing on this topic. They argue that the fierce independence of Third Wave feminism taught women to speak out and believe in their own power, but with little understanding of how to organize or create lasting legal or political change. Sigh. More information on the volume can be found [here](#).

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** published the chapter "The discursive eviction of Muslim women" in *The Routledge Handbook of Contemporary Feminist Rhetoric*, edited by Jacqueline Rhodes and Suban Nur Cooley. The

December 2024

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) attended the 2024 National Communication Association (NCA) conference in New Orleans, LA. She fulfilled her responsibilities as incoming Chair of the Feminist & Gender Studies Division. She also received a Distinguished Scholarship Award from the Critical/Cultural Studies Division for her co-authored article "De-whitening consent amidst COVID-19 rhetoric," published with Dr. Kate Lockwood Harris in the *Quarterly Journal of Speech*. While at NCA, LB caught up with SU alumna **Sofia Salmeron**, who is pursuing an M.A. in Communication Studies at Texas Christian University. Sofia presented her paper "You're not working hard enough...you're not trying hard enough: An analysis of privacy management and coping and resilience among your adults experiencing food insecurity." Congratulations to this outstanding alumna.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** engaged in the following activities during the 2024 National Communication Association (NCA) annual convention held in New Orleans on November 20–24: Presented the co-authored paper "Invoking Ethnic Identity in the Service of Right-Wing Rhetoric: A Rhetorical Analysis of 2022 GOP Latina Candidates in South Texas" in a session sponsored by the Latina/o Communication Studies Division; Participated in NCA's Scholars' Office Hours, a session in which a select

"Latina Communication Studies: Reframing Narratives of Latina Power, Theory, and Representation," also sponsored by the Latina/o Communication Studies Division; Participated as a mentor in the La Raza Caucus Mentorship Panel; and planned two sessions for the NCA Mentorship and Leadership Council, including a "Pathways to NCA Leadership" roundtable. For her two-year service to the Council, Moreira received a Presidential Citation of Service.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** received the Córdova-Puchot Scholar of the Year Award given by the National Communication Association's Latina/o Communication Studies Division. The award is the Division's highest honor, and it recognizes a scholar who has achieved a high level of excellence across the four areas of teaching, research, service, and advocacy. Moreira received the award during NCA's 2024 convention held in New Orleans on November 20-24.

November 2024

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** and Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Jaishikha Nautiyal** received the Monograph of the Year Award for their co-authored article "Queer desi kinships: Reaching across partition." The article appears in the Tier-1 journal *QED: A Journal in GLBTQ Worldmaking*, and articulates non-Western, and specifically South-Asian, queer praxes. The award is from the

October 2024

Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** presented a paper at the 9th meeting of the Nordic Rhetoric Association in Copenhagen, Denmark. The University of Copenhagen has distinguished itself as one of the finest rhetoric programs in Europe and is making a worldwide impact in rhetorical studies. The conference theme was “Technology in Transition,” and Dr. Renegar, along with her co-authors Dr. Stacey Sowards from UT Austin and Dr. Kristi Cole from NC State, presented a new piece on digital collaboration in research and teaching, and explored ways that these collaborations can function as mentoring opportunities. They focused on building and engaging in digital collaboration and the importance of horizontal mentoring and developing vulnerable relationships outside of an individual institution.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** has published the article “Invoking ethnic identity in the service of right-wing rhetoric: an analysis of 2022 Latina republican candidates in South Texas,” with Dr. Arthur Soto-Vásquez of the University of Nevada, Las Vegas, in *Communication, Culture, and Critique*. The essay examines campaign ads from three Latina GOP candidates in South Texas, in which Moreira and Soto-Vásquez identified the strategic deployment of conservative ethnic identity that disavows racialized identity through anti-immigrant rhetoric. Instead of moderating anti-immigration discourse, as has been suggested by observers on how to attract Latine voters, these candidates instead redirect the immigrant threat narrative towards other subgroups of Latines. The

The Communication Studies Department was well-represented at the 2024 Biennial Public Address Conference. This is a highly-selective, invitation-only conference that showcases scholarship and responses from leading scholars in Rhetoric and Communication Studies. The University of Texas at Austin hosted this conference September 22-25. Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) was one of the eight invited plenary speakers to the conference. She delivered an address, titled "Caste is not a metaphor," as a call to the field to grapple with its ignorance of caste, and to reckon with how caste bolsters "model minority" and white supremacist discourses. Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** responded to Dr. Angela Aguayo's plenary, "Youth Production as Public Address," in which she articulated a series of questions regarding the potential of networked space to produce liberatory content. Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Jaishikha Nautiyal** participated in a panel titled "Anti-DEI legislation in Texas" and presented her work on "anaerobic rhetoric," in light of the anti-DEI legislation in Florida, based on a forthcoming publication in *Quarterly Journal of Speech*.

July 2024

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** has published the essay "Working for the miracle: A critical, visual analysis of Disney's *Encanto*," along with co-authors Raisa Alvarado of California State University, San Bernardino and Carlos Flores of California State University, Sacramento, in the *International Journal of Communication*. The essay proposes a visual analysis of *Encanto*, with particular attention to the cultural tensions

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colonial ideologies of oligarchical governance, mestizaje, and postracism. The visual analysis of *Encanto* and its related paratexts contributes to scholarship on the labor of cultural translators on behalf of Disney, expanding it to include unaffiliated Disney audiences who digitally articulate histories of imperialism, displacement, and their contemporary counterparts for public audiences. The *International Journal of Communication* is an open access, double-blind peer-reviewed journal that is consistently among the top quartile of journals in communication with highest citation metrics worldwide. The essay can be read [here](#).

June 2024

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** presented on a featured “supersession” at the Rhetoric Society of America biennial conference. The panel focused on climate catastrophes, and Bahrainwala spoke about manual scavenging among Dalits, the framing of Muslims as “climate culprits,” and the ongoing green colonialism of Palestine.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** presented two papers at the Rhetoric Society of America Conference, held in Denver, CO, May 23-27. Moreira presented the essay “The Place of Blackness in U.S. Constructions of Latinidad,” in which she investigates Anzaldúa’s legacy of mestizaje and hybridity as foundational for the absence of

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** was among 30 scholars invited to participate in the Viral Movements Symposium, hosted at Penn State on May 14 and 15. The symposium was organized by Lisa Flores, the Josephine Berry Weiss Chair of the Humanities, and featured scholars from the humanities and life sciences to discuss the topics of (im)mobility, (mis)information, and (mis)management.

May 2024

Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** furthered her research agenda on the rhetoric surrounding stepmothers by presenting on Kamala Harris as an antidote to traditional stepmother stereotypes in Barcelona, Spain at the International Conference on Gender Research in late April.

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** presented a plenary talk titled “Bringing the Archives Out of the Archives: Mobilizing and Reframing University Archives in Critiques of Campus Commemorative Landscapes” at the Austin Archives Bazaar, held at Scholz Garten in Austin on April 14. The talk described the experience of developing the Placing Memory Interactive Story Map in Summer 2023 with **Megan Firestone**, Head of Distinctive Collections and Archives, and a team of 11 student researchers: **Bettina Castillo '24**, **Max Colley '24**, **Adrianna Flores-Vivas '24**, **Lainey Gutierrez '25**, **Teddy Hoffman '24**, **Hannah Jury '24**, **Shawn Maganda '24**, **Harper Randolph '25**, **Andrea Stanescu '24**, **Michelle Taing '24**, and **Ava Zumpano '25**.

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published an article along with co-author Dr. Jaishikha Nautiyal in the journal QED: A Journal in GLBTQ Worldmaking. The article, “Queer Desi Kinships: Reaching across Partition,” offers ethnographic accounts of how casteism, anti-Muslim sentiment, and anti desi-queerness diminish desi solidarities in white and western contexts, including academia. They argue that the 1947 Partition of Pakistan and India is still ongoing, and worldwide. Dr. Nautiyal is also joining the Communication Studies Department in Fall 2024, and we are very lucky to have her. The article can be read [here](#).

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** and SU students **R'Yani Vaughn '24** and **Sydney Wahl '24** attended the 2024 Western States Communication Association (WSCA) Undergraduate Scholars Research Conference in Reno, NV. Lamiyah supervised R'Yani and Sydney's senior projects, which were anonymously reviewed and competitively selected for presentation: "Exploring Depictions of Black Motherhood in the Music Industry," R'Yani Sydnee-LeChe' Vaughn, and "From Samoan Warrior to American Traitor: The Media Framing Creations plus Exceptionalism, Nationalism, and Masculine Perfectionism Reactions that hanger the Course of Football Star Manti Te'o's Life," Sydney Lee Wahl. Senior scholars as well as the WSCA President themself spoke with these students and attempted to recruit them to their graduate programs. Congratulations to these impressive students!

February 2024

Part-Time Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Katharine Hodgdon** has been appointed as a contributor for The Wall Street Journal's Critical Thinking Resources publication. This resource summarizes articles appearing in the Journal and provides thought-provoking, free-response questions to be used for class discussions. Katharine's contributions will focus on informative and persuasive communication techniques utilized by reporters and journalists to explain current events.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** published the article, "Rhetorics of authentic hybridity and the racially mobile mestiça in 'Girl from Rio,'" in the Quarterly Journal of Speech. The essay challenges common readings of Latinidad's racial hybridity as a transgressive in-betweenness against the Black/white racial binary, focusing instead on how this rhetorical construction produces racial mobility, specifically toward whiteness. The Quarterly Journal of Speech is the field's most prestigious journal, a peer-reviewed publication of the National Communication Association.

December 2023

Associate Professor and Chair of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) attended the 2023 National Communication Association conference, the discipline's flagship conference, in National Harbor, MD:

1. LB presented on three panels: a roundtable discussion on extractivism and energy justice, a roundtable discussion on the "bamboo ceiling" about challenges undercutting Asian scholars, and a co-authored-paper presentation on de-whitening consent amidst COVID-19 rhetoric.
2. LB received a Top Paper Award for her co-authored paper from the Critical/Cultural Studies Division.
3. LB assumed responsibility as elected Vice Chair of the Feminist and Gender Studies

- Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** participated in the following activities at the National Communication Association Annual Conference in National Harbor, MD, on November 15–19:

1. Presented on the necessity to decolonize childhood in the panel, "Intimate Freedoms: Building Decolonial Relations across Communicative Contexts."
 2. Presented on rethinking and rebuilding gendered and racialized structures in the panel, "Comadrismo Collective: Envisioning and Co-creating Communities of Care."
 3. Participated as an invited scholar in NCA's Scholars' Office Hours.
 4. Participated as a mentor in La Raza's Mentorship Gathering.
 5. Chaired the NCA Mentorship and Leadership Council business meeting.
 6. Responded to four papers in the session, "Narratives on Race, Nation, Masculinity, Anti-Blackness, and Fat-Phobia."
 7. Participated in both the NCA Executive Community and the Legislative Assembly meetings as a voting member.
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October 2023

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** has published the chapter, "Dragging White Femininity: Race and Gender Inauthenticity on Instagram," in *The Routledge Handbook of Ethnicity and Race in Communication*, published in October 2023.

September 2023

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** has published an article titled "Roadside Media: Roadside Crash Shrines as Platforms for Communicating Across Time, Space, and Mortality in the Early 2000s United States" in Cultural and Social History, The Journal of the Social History Society. The article traces the recent history of roadside shrines to show that they are not only entangled with other contemporary media forms but have also developed into miniaturized and materialized social media platforms. The article officially comes out in print later this winter and is now available [here](#).

Chair and Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published a new article titled "De-whitening consent amidst COVID-19 rhetoric" with her co-author Dr. Kate Lockwood Harris (UMN). This article appears in the Quarterly Journal of Speech, the #1 ranked journal in rhetoric. It discusses how existing consent rhetorics are constituted against the specter of Black Muslim women and calls for a de-whitening of consent norms by building on lessons learned from COVID-19. You can read more [here](#).

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Translating Communication Scholarship into Meaningful Practice" published by Kendall Hunt. [Read more here](#)

August 2023

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** has been selected to present on a "Top Paper Panel" at the 2023 National Communication Association conference. Her paper, co-authored with Dr. Kate Lockwood Harris, is titled "De-Whitening Consent Amidst COVID-19 Rhetoric" and examines how the r/ejection of Black Muslim women foundationalizes discourse on bodily autonomy and social distancing.

Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** visited Queens University, a liberal arts school in Charlotte, North Carolina, to conduct an academic program review of the undergraduate programs in the Knight School of Communication.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** published the essay, "'Didn't She Used to Sell That WAP?': Cardi B, Clashing Femininities, and Citizenship," in *Women's Studies in Communication*. The article argues that conservative reactions to Cardi B's performances of racialized and classed femininity on Twitter, especially from right-wing cisgender women, aimed to put the rapper "in her place," which is outside of politics and in opposition to (white) American values. Even though Cardi B's working-class Black femininity places her outside of discourses of normative U.S. citizenship and meritocracy, the rapper "makes herself at home" by engaging in civic practices regardless of the classist misogynoir directed at her. The article is available [here](#).

May 2023

Teddy Hoffman '24 presented a paper at the Communicating Diversity Conference at Texas A&M University on May 6, 2023. Her paper, "Resisting Geographies of Fear and Enacting a Safer World: Solo Female Travel Influencers and their Rhetorical Constructions," was supervised by Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar**. The paper received one of only two Top Undergraduate Paper prizes awarded at the conference.

Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** presented work related to her ongoing research program on step-mothering rhetoric in a paper about Kamala Harris at the

April 2023

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** received the Innovator Award for Most Outstanding Book from the Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity Caucus at the Central States Communication Association Annual Conference in St. Louis, MO, for her monograph, *Bitches Unleashed: Performance and Embodied Politics in Favela Funk*. At the conference, Moreira also presented the paper "The Right Girl from Rio: Anita's Crossover and Latinidad's Whiteness" and participated in the panel discussion "Effective Inclusive Pedagogical Practices by and for Silenced Voices."

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** gave an invited virtual talk on March 22 at the University of Minnesota Twin Cities on the topic of feminist collaboration. Bahrainwala spoke with graduate students in the seminar "Feminist Organizing" about possibilities for coalition building and the settler contours of "breaking ground" ideology in the academy.

March 2023

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** steered several student projects that were presented and recognized at a highly selective regional conference. Five Southwestern students traveled to Phoenix, Arizona, to present their research at the 2023 Undergraduate Scholars Research Conference hosted by the Western States Communication Association. This marks the third conference Bahrainwala has mentored her students through. Faculty reviewers and the conference Chair commended the students afterward and attempted to recruit them to their graduate programs. These outstanding students also swept the awards, winning three out of the four Top Paper Awards presented at this conference. Katie Love '23 won a Top Paper Award for her paper "It's About Damn Time: Lizzo's Impact on Fat Identity, Fat Celebrity, and Societal Perceptions of Fatness." Preston Willis '23 won a Top Paper Award for his paper "Queer Icons & Queering Iconography: Lady Gaga's Liberal Use of Religion in Born This Way." Jenna Baird '23 presented her paper "The Animalization of Blackness within Disney's Animated Films: New Imagined Ways of Being Racist." Jordan Preston '23 won a Top Paper Award for her paper "Miley Cyrus: White Feminism and Queernormativity in Contemporary Pop Culture." Caden Cox '23 presented his paper "Shaping Your Type: How Dating Apps Effect and Influence Queer Relationships For Men." This is the second time Cox was invited to present at this conference and received a Top Paper Award from this conference last year. Southwestern students Nina Mitrofanova '23 and Alli Ziehm '23 were also invited to present. Congratulations to these outstanding students!

Feburary 2023

Professor of Communications Studies **Valerie Renegar** and Kristi Cole co-edited the book *Refiguring Motherhood Beyond Biology*, which was published this month. The book features

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Bahrainwala, Professor of Spanish **Katy Ross**, and her student Bailey Barlow '23.

December 2022

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** and Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** attended the El Mundo Zurdo conference for the Society for the Study of Gloria Anzaldúa at the University of Texas at San Antonio from November 4-5. The roundtable that Bahrainwala and Sendejo co-organized was titled "Reflections on Radical Love, Care, and Consent: How Anzaldúa Informs Our Liberatory Praxis." Bahrainwala presented "Pandemic lessons: Consent as anti-Racism," and Sendejo presented "Movidas of Healing: The Spirit Work of Movement Era Chicanas." The roundtable was well attended by lead scholars in the field of Anzaldúan Thought.

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built for children.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** attended the National Communication Association Convention in New Orleans from November 16-19, during which time she received a Distinguished Scholarship Award for Top Article from the International and Intercultural Communication Division. Bahrainwala organized, chaired, and presented on a panel titled Queer Desi Kinship, exploring how queering the 1947 Partition of India and Pakistan offers non-Western lessons towards queer scholarship, and fulfilled her commitments as Second Vice-Chair of the Feminist and Women Studies Division.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** was an invited virtual speaker at Arizona State University in the graduate seminar Rhetorical Methods. Students read two of Bahrainwala's publications on equity work in the academy, and her talk focused on the role of critic in rhetorical criticism and maintaining energy while doing the difficult labor of critiquing inequitable structures.

- Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** engaged in a number of activities at the 2022 National Communication Association (NCA) Annual Convention in New Orleans. Moreira received the International and Intercultural Communication Division's Best Book Award for *Bitches Unleashed: Performance and Embodied Politics in Favela Funk*. Additionally, she presented the following papers:

1. "Mestiçagem and Racial spatiality in Anitta's 'Girl from Rio,'" co-planned paper session with Texas AM's Dr. Bryce Henderson and sponsored by the Critical and Cultural Studies Division.
2. "Dragging White Femininity: Pablio Vittar's Performances of Gender and Race on Instagram," paper session sponsored by the GLBTQ Communication Studies Division.
3. "Communication Needs Transfeminismo: How a Brazilian Political and Epistemological Movement Can Help Decolonize Our Discipline," presented in Portuguese for a multilingual panel about structural violence sponsored by NCA's First Vice President.

Finally, Moreira participated as a panelist in the following:

1. "Spotlight on Scholarship: New Books in Latina/o/x Communication Studies," sponsored by NCA's First Vice President.
2. "Publishing Race Scholarship in Communication Studies: Challenges Faced by Scholars of Color and/or International Scholars in the Field," sponsored by NCA's First Vice President.
3. "Latinx Faculty: Finding our PLACE in Predominantly White Institutions," sponsored by the La Raza Caucus.
4. "The Future of the La Raza Caucus: An Open Forum," a session co-chaired with Dr. Michelle Holling and sponsored by the La Raza Caucus.
5. "Shared Governance as a Place for Advocacy: Examining How the Neoliberal University is Dismantling Community Deliberation," sponsored by the Association for Communication Administration.

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** published an article titled "Trauma Remains: The Material Afterlives of the 1989 Alton School Bus Crash," in the October 2022 issue of the Journal of Material Culture. The article analyzes the ways a large roadside shrine in South Texas where 21 middle and high school students were killed in a crash in 1989 continues to quietly but forcefully reverberate as a site of collective trauma more than thirty years later.

August 2022

Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore** and Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** were invited to speak on a parent-education panel for Child's Day, a child development center in Austin, on the topic of talking to children about race. The well-attended panel, which featured K–12 educators and organizers, continued Moore's and Bahrainwala's public-education efforts on inclusion work.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** received the 2022 Fellows' Early Career Award from the Rhetoric Society of America. This award is presented each year to a scholar who has contributed significant, innovative, boundary-expanding research to the discipline. The nomination pool included tenured and associate professors and typically goes to scholars at research-leading institutions.

June 2022

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** was interviewed and quoted as an expert source for an *Los Angeles Times* profile featuring Brazilian pop star Anitta, who is set to perform at LA Pride 2022.

May 2022

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** supervised four student projects presented at the Communicating Diversity Student Conference 2022 hosted by Texas A&M University. Congratulations to the following scholars:

- **Mary Smith** '23: "Hegemonic Masculinity and Duke Cannon Supply Co."
- **Preston Willis** '23: "'Taylor Swift Doesn't Write Her Own Music': Discourse On Women's Ownership, Androcentrism in the Music Industry, and the Emergence of Swiftian Feminism"
- **Katie Love** '23: "Play it Again: The Story Behind Taylor Swift's Re-recordings and Professional Heartbreak"
- **Jessica Bettis** '23: "Tragedy at Astroworld: How Unintentional Loss Makes an

April 2022

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Rico Self** was invited to deliver the prestigious LSU Geaux Rhetoric Speaker Series keynote, which commands a national audience, on March 10. Self followed in the illustrious footsteps of renowned communication studies scholars Ersula Ore, Steven Salaita, and Jo Hsu. His keynote discussed black womanist and feminist rhetoric of the J-Settes, a collegiate women's dance line.

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** was one of the central people interviewed for *The Taking*, a feature-length documentary film by Alexandre O. Phillipe about Monument Valley. The film explores how Monument Valley, located on the border of Arizona and Utah but also within the Navajo Nation, has repeatedly been made into a symbol of the white settler myth of the American West by filmmakers and other media producers while denying Navajo sovereignty and subjectivity. *The Taking* has appeared at multiple film festivals in the last several months, including the BFI London Film Festival, Fantastic Fest in Austin, and the New Zealand International Film Festival.

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Saremba, to represent Southwestern University at the Southern States Communication Association Annual Convention in April. She presented a paper titled "Jill Biden, Resistance, and Stepmothering: Resilience in the Neoliberal Landscape" and was an invited guest on a panel focused on student accessibility and increasing diversity in online teaching.

Demi Tomasides '22 presented her paper "Othered: The Black and White Portrayal of Neurodiversity in *Grey's Anatomy*" at the 2022 Alpha Chi National Convention, held March 24–26 in Austin, Texas. Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** supervised her project.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** recently delivered two guest lectures: "Potty Politics" was delivered to honors undergraduate students at the University of Texas at Austin, and "Feminist Collaboration" was delivered to a feminist organizing graduate seminar at the University of Minnesota Twin Cities.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** steered several student projects that were accepted, presented, and recognized at a highly selective regional conference. The following Southwestern students traveled to Portland, Oregon, to present their research at the 2022 Undergraduate Scholars Research Conference hosted by the Western States Communication Association:

- **Maddie Brent** '22 presented her paper "An Investigation into the Netflix Original Show 'Love Is Blind' and the Subversive Racism and Homophobia Perpetuated through the Production of Carlton Morton's public 'Coming Out' Storyline."
- **Emily Funk** '23 presented her paper "Women and the Stars: Antifeminism in Critiques of Pop Astrology."
- **Amanda Smith** '23 presented her paper "The Invisible Labor of Fake Happy."
- **Demi Tomasides** '22 presented her paper "Othered: The Black and White Portrayal of Neurodiversity in 'Grey's Anatomy.'"
- **Caden Cox** '23 won the Top Paper Award for his paper "Call Me by Your Name: Lil Nas X and Queerness in Rap and Pop."

Southwestern students **Nina Mitrofanova** '23, **Alli Ziehm** '23, and **Bri McCalla** '22 also were invited to present. Congratulations to these outstanding students!

February 2022

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** steered several

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the Western States Communication Association:

- **Maddie Brent** '22 presented her paper "An Investigation into the Netflix Original Show 'Love Is Blind' and the Subversive Racism and Homophobia Perpetuated through the Production of Carlton Morton's public 'Coming Out' Storyline."
- **Emily Funk** '23 presented her paper "Women and the Stars: Antifeminism in Critiques of Pop Astrology."
- **Amanda Smith** '23 presented her paper "The Invisible Labor of Fake Happy."
- **Demi Tomasides** '22 presented her paper "Othered: The Black and White Portrayal of Neurodiversity in 'Grey's Anatomy.'"
- **Caden Cox** '23 won the Top Paper Award for his paper "Call Me by Your Name: Lil Nas X and Queerness in Rap and Pop."

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December 2021

The Department of Communication Studies took the National Communication Association (NCA) 107th Annual Convention by storm the weekend before Thanksgiving in Seattle. Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala**, Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira**, Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Rico Self**, and Professor of Communication Studies **Valerie Renegar** all presented research and participated in roundtable discussions on a variety of topics, including queer motherhood (Self), surveillance during transformative moments (Bahrainwala), comedy and

The faculty members also formed the cheering section when Moreira won the 2021 Bonnie Ritter Outstanding Feminist Book Award from NCA's Feminist and Gender Studies Division and Self won the 2021 Gerald R. Miller Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award. Because NCA is the largest professional organization for communication scholars, these presentations and awards designate an especially high level of achievement.

November 2021

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** engaged in a number of activities at the 2021 National Communication Association Annual Convention in Seattle. She presented the following papers:

- "'Didn't She Used to Sell that WAP?': Cardi B, Clashing Femininities, and Political Discourse on Twitter" in a paper session sponsored by the Feminist and Gender Studies Division
- "Leaving the Precarious Liberal Arts" in a paper session sponsored by the Economics, Communication, and Society Division

Additionally, Moreira participated as a panelist in the following:

- "Pandemic Parenthood: On Academia, Latina Motherhood, Exhaustion, and the Future," a panel she cowrote with Raisa Alvarado that was cosponsored by the La Raza and Women's caucuses
- "Renewing a Commitment to Mentorship in La Raza Caucus," an annual mentorship

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business meeting of the Latino/a Communication Studies Division and La Raza Caucus.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala**'s article titled "Shithole Rhetorics" was the lead article in the August 2021 issue of the *Journal of International and Intercultural Communication*.

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** presented a paper titled "Figuring the Cost of Automobility: Roadside Car Crash Shrines as the Materialization of Collective Trauma" at the International Association for the History of Transport, Traffic, and Mobility (T2M) 19th Annual Conference. The conference was hosted in Lisbon, Portugal, but conducted virtually from November 3–5.

October 2021

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** gave a guest talk at a

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bizarre videos of blindfolded Muslim men offering hugs to passersby.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** has won the 2021 Bonnie Ritter Outstanding Feminist Book Award from the National Communication Association's (NCA's) Feminist and Gender Studies Division for her book *Bitches Unleashed: Performance and Embodied Politics in Favela Funk* (Peter Lang, 2021). The annual award honors a recently published scholarly book in the field of communication that interrogates questions related to feminism, women studies, and gender. Moreira will be presented with the award in November at the NCA 107th Annual Convention in Seattle.

August 2021

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Raquel Moreira** has won the 2021 Organization for the Study of Communication, Language, and Gender's Anita Taylor Outstanding Award for her article "De-Whitening Intersectionality through Transfeminismo."

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awards for his dissertation up to four, and that's not including the 2021 RSA Dissertation Award Honorable Mention he just received.

July 2021

Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** presented a paper titled "Communicating with the Dead: Roadside Car Crash Shrines as Platforms for Bridging Time, Distance, and Mortality" at the Distant Communications Virtual Conference, hosted by Midlands4Cities and the Royal Historical Society, on July 21, 2021. This interdisciplinary conference based in the U.K. brought together international scholars interested in contextualizing the remote communication practices necessitated by the pandemic through historical antecedents and material-culture analogues for communicating across spatial, temporal, and cultural distance.

June 2021

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Rico Self** had a new essay published in the most recent version of *Women's Studies in Communication*. "'If You Cared about the People, You Would Have Cared about Me': Constructing Black Trans Allyship in *Chasing*:

May 2021

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Rico Self** won the Louisiana State University Department of Women and Gender Studies Outstanding Dissertation Award for 2020–2021. His dissertation, “Ties That Bind: Black Familyness and the Politics of Contingent Coalitions,” explores a range of Black coalitions from rhetorical, queer, and gender dimensions.

Please join us in congratulating the recipients of the following awards:

- 2021 Teaching Awards
 - Tenured: Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore**
 - Tenure-track: Assistant Professor of Business **Gabriela Flores**
 - Visiting, part-time, and staff with faculty rank: Director of General Chemistry Labs **Willis Weigand**
- 2021 Jesse E. Purdy Excellence in Scholarly and Creative Works Award
 - Tenured: Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar**
 - Tenure-track: Assistant Professor of History **Joseph Hower**

January 2021

The Communication Studies Department was well represented at this year's (virtual) National Communication Association Conference. Assistant Professor **Rico Self** gave several talks about Black femininity and anti-Black stereotyping in addition to chairing two panels and receiving a Top Paper Award in the Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual, Transgender, and Queer Communication Studies Division (woot!) for his coauthored paper "BbyMutha's Readings as Black Queer Feminine Refusal." Assistant Professor **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) gave two talks about rock-star fascism and menstrual surveillance in nonwhite contexts. Associate Professor **Valerie Renegar** gave a talk on coauthoring and collaborative scholarship in rhetorical studies. Overall, much knowledge was dropped.

September 2020

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published the article "Shithole Rhetorics" in the *Journal of International and Intercultural Communication*. LB has been preoccupied with potties, and it turns out that toileting discourse suffuses

August 2020

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** has had his book *Road Scars: Place, Automobility, and Road Trauma* published by Rowman & Littlefield in their *Place, Memory, Affect* series. The book, which argues that roadside car crash shrines visually, materially, and spatially demonstrate an unresolved cultural trauma embedded within American car culture, is based on nearly two decades of fieldwork in the Southwestern U.S. and features 172 original color photographs.

July 2020

Cargill Endowed Chair and Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore** and Margaret Root Brown Chair in Fine Arts and Professor of Music **Michael Cooper** collaborated with pianist Lara Downes to produce a crowdsourced recitation of the Civil Rights "Credo" of W. E. B. Du Bois for the podcast *We Need Gentle Truths for Now*, hosted by Alexandra Juhasz. Seven SU faculty and staff (Part-Time Instructor of Applied Music **Adrienne Inglis**, Associate Professor of Music **Jason Hoogerhyde**, Professor of Music **Kiyoshi Tamagawa**, Professor of Music **Lois Ferrari**, Sarofim School of Fine Arts Coordinator **Olivia Wise**, Assistant Dean for Student Multicultural Affairs **Terri Johnson**, and Associate Professor of

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Watson '13) participated in the recitation, along with 25 other participants Black and white, ages 5 to 81, from the Americas and Europe, representing four native languages. The podcast is available [here](#). The recitation is also available as a YouTube video titled "Testimony: A #BlackLivesMatter Manifesto after the Credo of W.E.B. Du Bois," [here](#).

June 2020

Part-Time Instructor of Communication Studies **Katie Bradford** has completed a Ph.D. in Communication Studies at The University of Texas at Austin. Her dissertation, "Moving between the Conversation 'at Hand' and the 'Handheld' Conversation: Participation in Family Dinners with Smartphones," investigates how people incorporate technology into their face-to-face interactions. Her research responds to contemporary concerns about smartphones and their impact on communication—and is novel because it is based on an analysis of video-recorded natural conversational data, not just surveys or observations.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala (LB)** published the article "Precarity, Citizenship, and the 'Traditional' Student" in the journal *Communication Education* some time this spring, when she had already stopped using a calendar. She is grateful to the Southwestern students who educated her about what their precarities look like. If you feel at all inclined to read it, LB suggests waiting until you are in a good place emotionally.

January 2020

Associate Professor of Communication Studies **Bob Bednar** presented a paper titled “Trauma Remains: The Material Temporalities of Objects Placed at Roadside Crash Shrines” at the Material Temporalities Workshop at the Max Planck Institute for the Study of Religious and Ethnic Diversity, in Göttingen, Germany, on January 23–24, 2020.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** (LB) published a chapter titled “Visible Allies and Muslim Inclusion” in the book *Academic Labor beyond the College Classroom: Working for Our Values* (edited by Holly Hassel and Kirsti Cole). The chapter discusses the Muslims in Academia Symposium that took place at Southwestern in spring 2019.

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